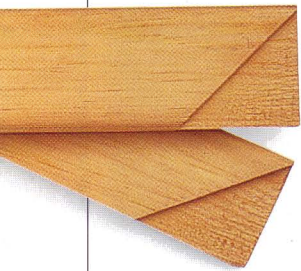
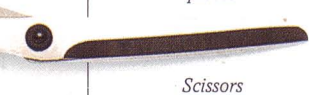


PREPARING SUPPORTS & GROUNDS

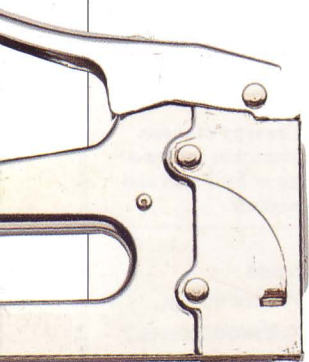
Materials



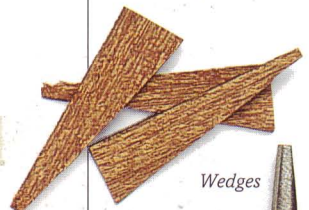
Wooden stretcher pieces



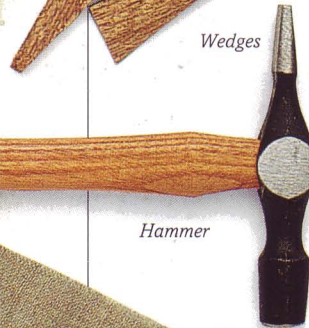
Scissors



Staple gun



Wedges



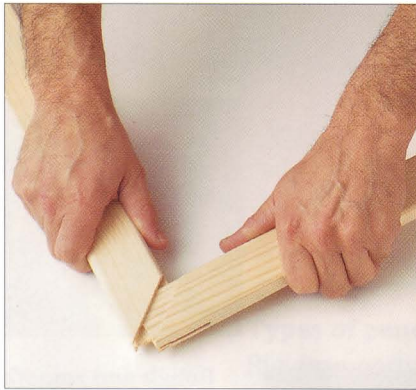
Hammer



Linen canvas

CHOOSE A SUPPORT that suits your painting style. It can be rigid and stable, such as a wooden panel made of oak or poplar, or more commonly of hardboard or plywood; or it can be flexible, made of cotton, linen, or polyester canvas. The ground is what you put on the surface of the support in order to prepare it for painting. The surface is initially sized to seal it and prevent oil from the paint from being absorbed into the wood or canvas. A primer, either toned or white, can then be applied over the dried sizing.

Stretching a canvas

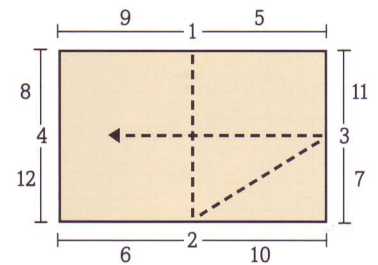
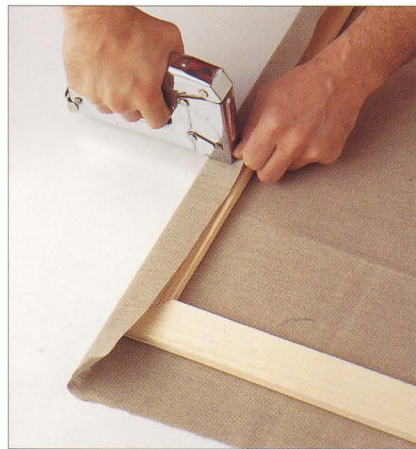


1 Start by slotting the four edges of the stretcher together. Tap a rubber hammer on each corner if the pieces become stuck.

2 Lay the stretcher over a large piece of canvas and then cut around it with scissors, leaving at least 3in (8cm) of canvas clear.



3 Stretch the linen canvas over the rigid wooden frame using thick staples and a staple gun. Put a staple in the frame wherever there is a number on the diagram (right). Work in number order. This ensures an even tension in the taut canvas. Fold the canvas over the frame firmly rather than pulling hard; if you stretch it too tight, it may begin to strain and distort.



The canvas must be stapled in a specific order



4 Once the sides of the canvas have been attached securely to the frame, maintain an even tension at each corner of the support by stapling down the overlapping material. Neatly make two folds out of the canvas and then pull one fold over the other. Secure the folds to the frame with a staple.



5 Finally, tap four wedges into each corner of the frame with the hammer. These wedges help to tighten the frame a little more, making it as rigid and as taut as possible.